

Dr. Tarita Shankar: Building Future-Ready Leaders for a Viksit Bharat



Tarita Shankar

President, Indira University - Chairperson & Chief Mentor, Indira Group of Institutes

As India moves towards its centenary of independence in 2047, the vision of Viksit Bharat @ 2047 places human capital at the centre of national transformation. A developed India will require economic growth and technological advancement, along with responsible, innovative, and globally competent leaders. Few educationists have contributed to this mission, including Dr. Tarita Shankar, President of Indira University and Chairperson & Chief Mentor of the Indira Group of Institutes.

A Harvard graduate and visionary academic leader, Dr. Tarita Shankar has spent over three decades redefining higher education through a philosophy that goes beyond academic excellence to nurture leadership, innovation, entrepreneurship, and social responsibility. What began in 1994 as the Indira Group of Institutes evolved into Indira University in 2025, marking a remarkable journey built on relevance, quality, and an unwavering commitment to student success.

At the heart of Dr. Tarita Shankar's educational philosophy lies a simple yet powerful belief: education must not merely inform; it must transform. Under her leadership, thousands of students have been empowered with the knowledge, confidence, and values needed to thrive in an increasingly complex world. Her vision has always focused on creating graduates who are both career-ready and nation-ready.

Indira University offers various UG, PG, and Doctoral programmes under its Schools, such as the School of Business, the School of Commerce and Computer Applications, the School of Information Technology, the School of Liberal Arts, and the School of Pharmacy. Recognising the demands of a rapidly changing global economy, Dr. Tarita Shankar has ensured that Indira University remains future-focused. The introduction of MBA specialised programmes in Global Finance and Digital Marketing & AI, and the launch of a new school, the School of Engineering, that offers B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering with specialisations in Artificial Intelligence, Data Science, Cyber Security, and Cloud Technology, reflects her commitment to preparing students for emerging industries and evolving workforce requirements.

Further strengthening this future-ready

approach, Indira University has built a strong ecosystem of global academic collaborations and industry partnerships. This year, the University significantly expanded its international footprint through academic agreements with De Montfort University (UK), Korea University, KUT University College (Iraq), and SEGi University (Malaysia), creating opportunities for student exchanges and international learning programmes. On the industry front, partnerships with eClerx Services, Philips India, Solar Industries India, Berger Paints, Knorr-Bremse Technology



Centre India, Ultra Corpotech, Fun and Joy at Work, Sohum Global Education, Sunward Growth Advisory, Gryphon Academy, and Ayush Anand Yog Institute are helping bridge the gap between academia and industry through experiential learning, internships, live projects, and enhanced career opportunities.

Through its industry-relevant curriculum, experiential learning opportunities, and strong industry engagement, Indira University contributes to 90–95% employability outcomes for its students, ensuring graduates are well-prepared for evolving career opportunities in India and across the globe.

Her vision extends well beyond the classroom. Through collaborations with global universities like the Korea University and industry leaders, students gain access to international internships, global immersion programmes, live industry projects, and cross-cultural learning experiences. National and rural immersion initiatives further expose students to India's diverse realities, helping them develop empathy, adaptability, and a deeper understanding of societal challenges.

A strong advocate of innovation and entrepreneurship, Dr. Tarita Shankar has spearheaded initiatives such as the Swakiyam Foundation for Incubation and Innovation, which nurtures aspiring en-

trepreneurs through mentorship, industry engagement, and startup support. Equally significant are platforms such as Yogakshem, the Centre for Policy, Governance and Impact, which promotes the philosophy of "Vyakti Nirman se Rashtra Nirman" by encouraging students to engage with public policy, governance, grassroots development, and social impact initiatives. Through experiential learning, NGO collaborations, and community-based projects, students learn that leadership is inseparable from service.

Complementing this is Vishwa Chintan, the Centre for Global Thought Leadership, which connects students and faculty with international experts, policymakers, researchers, and industry leaders, and the Centre for Artificial Intelligence.

Dr. Tarita Shankar's commitment to holistic development is also reflected in the vibrant student ecosystem at Indira University. Student-led clubs such as SheCan, The Groove Club, The Wild Ones, The Stage Craft, and The Capture Crew provide opportunities for leadership, creativity, teamwork, and self-expression, ensuring that learning extends far beyond academic achievement.

Her contributions have earned prestigious recognitions, including the Exemplary Leadership Award, the Visionary Leader Award, and recognition among India's leading CEOs in education. Yet, Dr. Shankar measures success not through awards, but through the accomplishments and impact of her students.

As India advances towards the vision of a Viksit Bharat, leaders like Dr. Tarita Shankar are shaping the nation's future by building institutions that create thinkers, innovators, entrepreneurs, and changemakers. Her journey stands as a powerful testament to the transformative role of education in nation-building and the creation of a more prosperous, inclusive, and globally respected India.